

C212

Marketing

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A sporting-goods chain with 45 stores across the Southeast launched a loyalty app last year. It now groups customers by how often they buy and whether they are first-time or repeat buyers, and it sends different offers to each group. Which segmentation basis is the chain using?

- A. Demographic.
- B. Geographic, because the stores are in the Southeast.
- C. Psychographic.
- D. Behavioral.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A marketer wants to segment customers psychographically. Which variable should she use?

- A. Age, because age always determines lifestyle.
- B. Lifestyle, such as outdoor-adventure versus home-focused.
- C. How many times a year the customer buys.
- D. Household income.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A coffee chain's new location in a suburban mall has heavy foot traffic, but many people walk in, look at the menu and leave without buying. The chain can access a government census report and an industry report on national coffee consumption. Its CEO started as a barista. Which data would best explain why these visitors leave?

- A. Secondary data only, since it is always cheaper and good enough.
- B. The census report on the mall's surrounding area.
- C. The industry report on national coffee consumption.
- D. Primary data, such as short exit interviews and observation at the store.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A couple bought a \$42,000 SUV after comparing three models for several weeks. The dealership has been family-owned since 1978. A week after the purchase, they start wondering whether one of the other models would have been the better choice. What is happening, and what should the dealer's marketing do?

- A. Nothing; once the sale closes, marketing's job is done.
- B. Information search; send them more ads comparing the three models.
- C. Post-purchase dissonance; follow up to reassure them, for example with a check-in call and a message reinforcing the vehicle's strengths.
- D. Need recognition; offer them a trade-in deal on a new vehicle.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A smart-thermostat maker saw years of rapid sales growth, but sales have now leveled off. Most households that want a smart thermostat already have one, and competitors are cutting prices to win share. The company moved its headquarters to Denver last year. Which life-cycle stage is the product in, and what strategy fits?

- A. Maturity; differentiate the product and defend market share.
- B. Introduction; spend heavily to build basic awareness.
- C. Decline; stop investing and withdraw the product.
- D. Growth; expand distribution rapidly to reach new buyers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A new energy-drink brand, started by two college friends, spends most of its promotion budget on trade allowances, shelf-placement fees and bonuses for sales reps who get distributors and grocery chains to stock it. The drink has 120 milligrams of caffeine. Which promotion strategy is it using?

- A. Pull strategy.
- B. Push strategy.
- C. Pull strategy, because energy drinks are consumer products.
- D. Direct marketing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company chooses a pull strategy for a new snack. Which activity fits?

- A.** Heavy consumer advertising and coupons so shoppers ask stores for the snack.
- B.** Paying retailers slotting fees for shelf space.
- C.** Social media only, since pull strategies never use traditional ads.
- D.** Sending sales reps to call on wholesalers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A luxury watchmaker, founded in Geneva in 1890, sells its watches through only one authorized jeweler in each major city. It says the policy protects its image and lets dealers give expert service. Which distribution intensity is this?

- A.** Intensive distribution.
- B.** Selective distribution.
- C.** Exclusive distribution.
- D.** Direct distribution.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A new video-streaming service is entering a crowded market. Customers are price-sensitive and can switch services in minutes, and the company's costs per subscriber fall sharply as it grows. Its engineering team of 200 is based in Seattle. Which launch pricing strategy fits best?

- A.** Price skimming.
- B.** Penetration pricing.
- C.** Prestige pricing.
- D.** Cost-plus pricing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under which conditions is price skimming most appropriate?

- A.** An innovative, patent-protected product with early buyers willing to pay a premium.
- B.** A new product entering a market with many similar competitors.
- C.** Any new product, since high launch prices always work.
- D.** A price-sensitive mass market with low barriers to entry.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A boutique owned by a former fashion designer buys a wool jacket from a supplier in Portugal for \$60. The boutique uses a 40% markup on selling price. What should the jacket's selling price be?

- A.** \$84
- B.** \$24
- C.** \$100
- D.** \$36

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A retailer sells a lamp for \$150 using a 30% markup on selling price. What did the lamp cost the retailer?

- A.** \$115.38
- B.** \$195
- C.** \$45
- D.** \$105

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A sporting-goods chain ~~with 45 stores across the Southeast launched a loyalty app last year.~~ It now groups customers by how often they buy and whether they are first-time or repeat buyers, and it sends different offers to each group. Which segmentation basis is the chain using?

Target word: segmentation basis **Decides:** Grouping by purchase frequency and loyalty.

A	Adjacent category	Demographic covers traits such as age and income.
B	Camouflage	Store locations do not decide how customers are grouped here.
C	Confusion set	Psychographic covers lifestyle and values, not buying frequency.
D	Correct	Usage rate and loyalty status are behavioral variables.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A marketer wants to segment customers psychographically. Which variable should she use?

Target word: a psychographic variable **Decides:** Psychographic = lifestyle, values, personality.

A	Absolute language	Age is demographic, and people of the same age can have very different lifestyles.
B	Correct	Lifestyle is a core psychographic variable.
C	Confusion set	Purchase frequency is behavioral.
D	Adjacent category	Income is demographic.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A coffee chain's new location in a suburban mall has heavy foot traffic, but many people walk in, look at the menu and leave without buying. The chain can access a government census report and an industry report on national coffee consumption. ~~Its CEO started as a barista.~~ Which data would best explain why these visitors leave?

Target word: best data source **Decides:** The question is specific to this store's visitors.

A	Absolute language	Secondary data is cheaper but often cannot answer a specific local question.
B	Confusion set	Secondary data on residents cannot explain in-store decisions.
C	Adjacent category	National trends do not explain this store's walk-outs.
D	Correct	Only data collected now, for this question, can explain these visitors' behavior.

4. Answer C Concept 3

A couple bought a \$42,000 SUV after comparing three models for several weeks. ~~The dealership has been family-owned since 1978.~~ A week after the purchase, they start wondering whether one of the other models would have been the better choice. What is happening, and what should the dealer's marketing do?

Target word: stage and response **Decides:** Doubt after a big purchase is post-purchase dissonance.

A	Absolute language	Post-purchase behavior drives repeat sales and word of mouth.
B	Adjacent category	They have already bought; the search stage is over.
C	Correct	Reassurance after the sale reduces dissonance and builds loyalty.
D	Confusion set	Need recognition starts the process; they are at the end of it.

5. Answer A Concept 4

A smart-thermostat maker saw years of rapid sales growth, but sales have now leveled off. Most households that want a smart thermostat already have one, and competitors are cutting prices to win share. ~~The company moved its headquarters to Denver last year.~~ Which life-cycle stage is the product in, and what strategy fits?

Target word: stage and strategy **Decides:** Flat sales, saturated market, price competition.

A	Correct	Leveling sales and fierce competition mark maturity.
B	Inverted operation	Introduction is the opposite end; most target buyers already own one.
C	Confusion set	Decline has falling sales; these are flat, not falling.
D	Adjacent category	Growth has rising sales; these sales have leveled off.

6. Answer B Concept 5

A new energy-drink brand, ~~started by two college friends,~~ spends most of its promotion budget on trade allowances, shelf-placement fees and bonuses for sales reps who get distributors and grocery chains to stock it. ~~The drink has 120 milligrams of caffeine.~~ Which promotion strategy is it using?

Target word: push or pull **Decides:** Promotion is aimed at channel members.

A	Inverted operation	Pull targets end consumers so they ask retailers for it.
B	Correct	Incentives to distributors and retailers push the product through the channel.
C	Camouflage	Product type does not decide the strategy; who receives the promotion does.
D	Adjacent category	Direct marketing reaches consumers without intermediaries.

7. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A company chooses a pull strategy for a new snack. Which activity fits?

Target word: a pull activity **Decides:** Pull = promotion aimed at end consumers.

A	Correct	Consumer demand pulls the product through the channel.
B	Inverted operation	Payments to channel members are push.
C	Absolute language	Pull can use any consumer-facing medium.
D	Confusion set	Personal selling to the trade is push.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A luxury watchmaker, ~~founded in Geneva in 1890,~~ sells its watches through only one authorized jeweler in each major city. It says the policy protects its image and lets dealers give expert service. Which distribution intensity is this?

Target word: distribution intensity **Decides:** One outlet per market area.

A	Inverted operation	Intensive places the product in as many outlets as possible.
B	Adjacent category	Selective uses several chosen outlets per area, not one.
C	Correct	One or very few outlets per area is exclusive.
D	Confusion set	Direct means no intermediary; here jewelers sit between maker and buyer.

9. Answer B Concept 7

A new video-streaming service is entering a crowded market. Customers are price-sensitive and can switch services in minutes, and the company's costs per subscriber fall sharply as it grows. ~~Its engineering team of 200 is based in Seattle.~~ Which launch pricing strategy fits best?

Target word: launch pricing strategy **Decides:** Price-sensitive buyers, low switching costs, economies of scale.

A	Inverted operation	Skimming needs buyers willing to pay a premium and little competition.
B	Correct	A low price wins share fast, and scale economies make it sustainable.
C	Adjacent category	Prestige pricing signals quality through a high price; not a fit for price-sensitive buyers.
D	Confusion set	Cost-plus ignores the competitive and demand conditions that decide this case.

10. Answer A Concept 7 • transfer

Under which conditions is price skimming most appropriate?

Target word: conditions for skimming **Decides:** Skimming needs eager buyers and protection from competitors.

A	Correct	Protection and eager buyers let a high price hold.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the protection skimming needs; rivals would undercut the price.
C	Absolute language	Skimming fits only certain conditions.
D	Inverted operation	Those conditions favor penetration.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A boutique ~~owned by a former fashion designer~~ buys a wool jacket from a supplier in Portugal for \$60. The boutique uses a 40% markup on selling price. What should the jacket's selling price be?

Target word: selling price **Decides:** Markup is 40% of the selling price, so cost is 60% of price.

A	Confusion set	$\$60 \times 1.40$ applies a 40% markup on cost.
B	Dropped element	40% of \$60 is only a markup amount, not a price.
C	Correct	$\$60 / (1 - 0.40) = \100 ; markup \$40 is 40% of \$100.
D	Inverted operation	$\$60 \times 0.60$ multiplies instead of dividing.

12. Answer D Concept 8 • transfer

A retailer sells a lamp for \$150 using a 30% markup on selling price. What did the lamp cost the retailer?

Target word: solve for cost **Decides:** Cost = price $\times$ (1 – markup %).

A	Confusion set	$\$150 / 1.30$ treats the markup as a markup on cost.
B	Inverted operation	$\$150 \times 1.30$ adds the markup instead of removing it.
C	Adjacent category	That is the markup amount, not the cost.
D	Correct	$\$150 \times 0.70 = \105 .

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Segmentation bases	Demographic = who they are; geographic = where they are; psychographic = lifestyle, values and personality; behavioral = how they buy and use (usage rate, loyalty, benefits sought).	Calling any customer data “demographic,” or confusing lifestyle with buying behavior.	The variable used to group customers.
2	Primary vs. secondary research	Secondary data already exists for another purpose; primary data is collected now for the specific question.	Using broad existing reports to answer a narrow, local “why” question.	A very specific question about the firm's own customers or location.
3	Post-purchase dissonance	After a big, hard-to-reverse purchase, buyers often doubt their choice; marketers reduce this by reassuring them after the sale.	Thinking marketing ends at the sale.	A buyer second-guessing a costly purchase after buying.
4	Product life cycle	Introduction builds awareness; growth adds features and distribution; maturity defends share and differentiates as sales level off; decline harvests or drops.	Reading many competitors and price cuts as growth.	The shape of the sales curve and the intensity of competition.
5	Push vs. pull strategy	Push promotes to channel members (trade allowances, personal selling) so they stock and sell; pull promotes to end consumers so they ask for the product.	Classifying by the product type instead of by who receives the promotion.	Where the promotion budget goes: to distributors or to consumers.
6	Distribution intensity	Intensive = as many outlets as possible; selective = some chosen outlets; exclusive = one or very few outlets per area.	Calling any limited distribution “selective.”	How many outlets per market area, and why.
7	Skimming vs. penetration pricing	Skimming sets a high launch price for innovative, protected products with eager early buyers; penetration sets a low price to win share fast in price-sensitive markets.	Assuming every new product should start high.	Price sensitivity, competition and barriers to entry at launch.
8	Markup on selling price	With markup on selling price, $\text{price} = \text{cost} / (1 - \text{markup } \%)$; $\text{cost} = \text{price} \times (1 - \text{markup } \%)$.	Applying the percentage to cost instead of to price.	“Markup on selling price” or “markup on retail.”

Course scope (public description): Marketing Fundamentals introduces students to principles of the marketing environment, social media, consumer behavior, marketing research, and market segmentation. Students will also explore marketing strategies that are related to products and services, distribution channels, promotions, sales, and pricing.